

Sunday, 4 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

20° 10°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

18° 9°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

16° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

UK-Iranian dual national arrested over RAF Fairford released on bail.

The 25-year-old man was arrested in the London borough of Westminster on Thursday.

POLITICS · UK

2

Kemi Badenoch has cemented her image. Now she wants to put her party back on the big stage.

The Conservative leader is expected to set out a return to core conservative principles at the party's annual conference.

POLITICS · UK

3

Sinfield completes final ultramarathon challenge.

Sir Kevin Sinfield crosses the finish line at Old Trafford after seven ultramarathons in seven days.

UK · NEWS

4

Greens would offer two-year jobs to unemployed under-24s.

Co-deputy leader Mothin Ali tells the party's conference many young people are "bored, desperate and lost".

UK · NEWS

5

Huge crowds turn out in support of residents over Drumcree parade dispute.

The Police Service of Northern Ireland said anyone found to have blocked the Garvaghy Road will be treated as participating in an "illegal protest".

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Traitors claim their first victim as Richard E Grant tries to save his skin.**
There was a murder and a recruitment in the latest episode, and that was just in the opening minutes.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Alison Hammond returns home from hospital after rushing off This Morning.**
The This Morning presenter said she believes she experienced a panic attack on Friday's show.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Spoiler alert! Is social media ruining big gig surprises?.**
Big moments from headline acts are shared online long before many fans see their favourite artists.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Olivia Dean accused of copying Bill Withers' Just The Two of Us.**
The star's record label is sued over similarities between her song I've Seen It and Withers' classic.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Noel Gallagher guitar sells for £12,000 at auction.**
The instrument was one of a number of items which belonged to a former Oasis sound engineer.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Who was the best player on the pitch? - England player ratings.

England produce one of their best performances in recent times as they thump Croatia 6-0 in Rijeka. How did our report rate the players' performances?

SPORT · UK

2

'I want to discover Manchester' - Olid hunts recommendations.

Manchester United manager Eva Olid says she is "asking for recommendations" as she prepares to look around the city for the first time during the international break

SPORT · UK

3

Republic of Ireland news conference ends abruptly amid accusations.

Republic of Ireland manager Heimir Hallgrímsson's pre-match news conference ends abruptly as accusations are levelled at his players.

SPORT · UK

4

Sinfield completes final ultramarathon challenge.

Sir Kevin Sinfield crosses the finish line at Old Trafford after seven ultramarathons in seven days.

SPORT · UK

5

Wu thrashes Trump to set up Yuan final in Shenzhen.

Chinese world champion Wu Yize wins six consecutive frames to beat Judd Trump 6-1 at the Shenzhen Open and set up a final against countryman Yuan Sijun.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that 'the quiet joy of seeing a perfectly stacked pile of freshly laundered towels' can be surprisingly therapeutic.**
Researchers observed participants experiencing a noticeable lift in mood and a reduction in stress simply by looking at neatly organised linen. It seems a bit of domestic order can do wonders!
- 2 The delightful trend of 'sending postcards to strangers' in different towns across the UK is gathering pace.**
Participants find a random address and send a cheerful, anonymous note about their local area, creating unexpected moments of connection and brightening someone's day.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'listening to the gentle hum of a distant lawnmower' on a sunny afternoon.**
This particular ambient sound is thought to evoke feelings of peacefulness and evoke pleasant summer memories, making it a surprisingly effective stress-reducer.
- 4 A charming movement encourages people to 'collect different types of leaves' from their local park and turn them into small, imaginative art pieces.**
It's a simple way to appreciate nature's beauty and engage in a little creative, low-cost fun for all ages.
- 5 Research shows that 'the simple act of watering houseplants' can significantly boost feelings of wellbeing.**
The routine, the connection with nature, and watching something grow all contribute to a positive mental state, even for those without a sprawling garden.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for 'the comforting ritual of polishing shoes'.**
Many are rediscovering this traditional activity, finding the focused, repetitive motion and the satisfying shine to be a mindful and relaxing experience.
- 7 A new study reveals that 'the distinct smell of freshly baked bread' can trigger feelings of nostalgia and happiness more powerfully than almost any other aroma.**
It's not just hunger; it seems the scent taps into deep-seated memories of home and comfort.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: ...TAPPING THE BAR AGAINST THE TABLE TO HEAR THE 'SNAP' QUALITY!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: ...TAKING A DEEP, THEATRICAL SNIFF OF THE STEAM BEFORE THE FIRST SIP!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't seen one in years?

Is there a specific biscuit that, with just one bite, transports you back in time and makes you feel all warm and fuzzy? Tell us which one and why!

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's that little gesture, perhaps holding a door or letting you go first, that always puts a smile on your face and makes you think, 'ah, that was nice'?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'dandelion' is actually edible from root to flower, and every part of it can be used in different ways, from salads to coffee substitutes?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be heard as a faint crackling or rustling sound, like static on a radio, when they are particularly bright.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public railway opened in England in 1825, connecting Stockton and Darlington.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented in 1957 as 3D wallpaper.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Humans share 50% of their DNA with bananas.
- The British Isles are home to over 60 species of butterflies.

On this day

Day 277 of the year, 88 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amun; Christian feast day: Aurea of Paris; Christian feast day: Francis of Assisi Conclusion of Creationtide; Christian feast day: Blessed Francis Xavier Seelos. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — M. Ward, American singer-songwriter
- 1948 — Duke Robillard, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Rachael Leigh Cook, American actress
- 1958 — Anneka Rice, Welsh radio and television host
- 1956 — Christoph Waltz, Austrian-German actor
- 1946 — Susan Sarandon, American actress and activist
- 1959 — Tony Meo, English snooker player
- 1979 — Caitríona Balfe, Irish actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — Richard Noble sets a new land speed record of 633.468 miles per hour (1,019.468 km/h) at the Black Rock Desert in Nevada.
- 1958 — The current constitution of France is adopted.
- 2001 — Siberia Airlines Flight 1812 crashes after being struck by an errant Ukrainian missile. Seventy-eight people are killed.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1925 — Great Syrian Revolt: Rebels led by Fawzi al-Qawuqji capture Hama from the French Mandate of Syria.
- 2017 — Joint Nigerien-American Special Forces are ambushed by Islamic State militants outside the village of Tongo Tongo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2004 — SpaceShipOne wins the Ansari X Prize for private spaceflight.
- 1993 — Battle of Mogadishu occurs killing 18 U.S. Special Forces, two UN Peacekeepers and at least 600 Somali militia men and civilians.

- 1920 — The Mannerheim League for Child Welfare, a Finnish non-governmental organization, is founded on the initiative of Sophie Mannerheim.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 278 of the year, 87 days left in 2026. Today World Space Week (October 4–10); Armed Forces Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Anna Schäffer; Christian feast day: Charitina of Amisus. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Brooke Valentine, American singer and songwriter
- 1950 — Jeff Conaway, American actor and singer (died 2011)
- 1984 — Naima Adedapo, American singer and dancer
- 1951 — Bob Geldof, Irish singer-songwriter and actor
- 1959 — Kelly Joe Phelps, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1957 — Bernie Mac, American actor, comedian, producer, and screenwriter (died 2008)
- 1948 — Russell Mael, American vocalist
- 1978 — James Valentine, American musician and songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1985 — Seven Israeli vacationers, including four children, are killed in a mass shooting at Ras Burqa in the Sinai Peninsula by an Egyptian soldier.
- 1943 — World War II: Pacific Theater: Ninety-eight American POWs are executed by Japanese forces on Wake Island.
- 1982 — Tylenol products are recalled after bottles in Chicago laced with cyanide cause seven deaths.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1990 — After 150 years The Herald newspaper in Melbourne, Australia, is published for the last time as a separate newspaper.
- 2000 — Mass demonstrations in Serbia force the resignation of Slobodan Milošević.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar